

JOSHUA MEDINA

Lighting Artist | Real-Time Lighting & Technical Art

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PROFILE

Lighting Artist with a technical-art background focused on real-time and cinematic lighting for VFX and interactive experiences. Brings 6+ years of professional visual-production experience across photography and cinematography, alongside an MSc Computer Animation and Visual Effects at Bournemouth University and production-focused Lighting for Visual Effects training at Lost Boys | School of VFX. Hands-on Unreal Engine 5 experience with Lumen, Sequencer, Cine Cameras, exposure and atmospheric effects, supported by Maya, Katana, Arnold, RenderMan, Houdini/Karma and Nuke. Strong foundation in color theory, composition, HDRI/HDR IBL workflows, physically based rendering, shader/material response and visual storytelling, with Python/C++ experience in debugging, validation and workflow optimization. Interested in immersive storytelling and adaptable to proprietary production toolsets.

SELECTED REAL-TIME LIGHTING / RENDERING PROJECTS

Broken Horizons - Real-Time Lighting Artist | Unreal Engine 5 | Bournemouth University

- Created cinematic environment and shot lighting in UE5 using Lumen, Sequencer, Cine Cameras, exposure controls, atmospheric fog and Movie Render Queue; focused on mood, color, contrast, readability, continuity and narrative focus.

AOVGuard 2.0 - Render Validation / Pipeline Tool | Python | OpenEXR | pytest

- Developed automated EXR/AOV validation for lighting and compositing workflows, identifying invalid data and consistency issues while building repeatable QC, testing and debugging processes for reliable production handoff.

RenderMan Procedural Rendering Project | Python | RenderMan

- Built a physically based rendered asset using BRDF shading, materials, HDRI image-based lighting, reflections, detailed surface response and depth of field; refined lighting and material response through final polish.

Going Merry Ocean Simulation - FX / Lighting | Houdini | Solaris | Karma

- Built and lit an animated ocean/ship sequence using FLIP and ocean workflows, scene assembly, shading, materials, reflections and final rendering in Solaris/Karma, balancing atmosphere and visual continuity.

Render Farm Tool - Pipeline Development | Python | Maya | Houdini | Qube

- Developing scene, dependency and render-submission validation to improve troubleshooting, production reliability and workflow efficiency across Maya/Houdini rendering pipelines.

CORE SKILLS

Real-Time Lighting: Unreal Engine 5, Lumen, Sequencer, cinematic/environment lighting, dynamic real-time lighting, exposure, atmospheric effects, color/contrast, visual hierarchy, Movie Render Queue

Lighting / Rendering: Maya, Katana, Arnold, RenderMan, Houdini, Solaris, Karma, HDRI, HDR IBL workflows, image-based lighting, physically based rendering (PBR), PBR pipelines, shader/material response, reflections, render optimization

Lighting TD / Pipeline: Python, C++, Windows, source control (Git/GitHub), debugging, bug/issue triage, AOV/EXR workflows, render validation, production QC, automation, workflow optimization, pytest

Compositing / Post-Processing: Nuke, Photoshop, DaVinci Resolve, After Effects, color grading, cinematography, photography, composition, camera/lens fundamentals, visual storytelling

EDUCATION & TRAINING

MSc Computer Animation and Visual Effects | Bournemouth University | Sep 2025 - Sep 2026

- Computer graphics, real-time rendering, lighting, simulation, software engineering, pipeline and technical direction.

Certificate Diploma in Lighting for Visual Effects | Lost Boys | School of VFX, Montreal | Oct 2023 - Feb 2024

- Production-focused shot lighting and rendering training using Katana, Maya, Arnold and Nuke, including AOV and compositing workflows.

Bachelor's Degree in Digital Communication Design Engineering | Universidad Autónoma de Guadalajara

- Multidisciplinary training in cinematography, photography, visual communication, 3D production, design and programming fundamentals.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Assistant Cinematographer | Lightoon Films | 1 year 6 months

Supported camera, lens and lighting workflows on film productions, contributing to framing, exposure, color, visual continuity and collaboration with directors and cinematographers.

Professional Photographer | Self-Employed | Dec 2019 - Present

6+ years delivering portrait and commercial photography with hands-on responsibility for lighting, composition, exposure, color, camera operation, retouching and consistent final-image quality.